

039. Chapter 3 Verses 35-37

Lectures by Swami Sarvapriyananda

VERSE 3.35

श्रेयान्स्वधर्मो विगुणः परधर्मात्स्वनुष्ठितात् ।
स्वधर्मे निधनं श्रेयः परधर्मो भयावहः ॥ 35 ॥

śhreyān swa-dharmo viguṇaḥ para-dharmāt sv-anuṣṭhitāt
swa-dharme nidhanam śhreyaḥ para-dharmo bhayāvahaḥ

śhreyān—better; **swa-dharmaḥ**—personal duty; **viguṇaḥ**—tinged with faults; **para-dharmāt**—than another’s prescribed duties; **su-anuṣṭhitāt**—perfectly done; **swa-dharme**—in one’s personal duties; **nidhanam**—death; **śhreyaḥ**—better; **para-dharmaḥ**—duties prescribed for others; **bhaya-āvahaḥ**—fraught with fear

One’s own duty, ill-performed and without merit, is better than the duty of another well-discharged. Better is death in discharging one’s own duty. Another’s duty is fraught with fear.

VERSE 3.36

अर्जुन उवाच ।

अथ केन प्रयुक्तोऽयं पापं चरति पूरुषः ।

अनिच्छन्नपि वार्ष्णेय बलादिव नियोजितः ॥ 36 ॥

arjuna uvācha

atha kena prayukto 'yaṁ pāpaṁ charati pūruṣhaḥ

anichchhann api vārṣhṇeya balād iva niyojitaḥ

arjunaḥ uvācha—Arjun said; **atha**—then; **kena**—by what; **prayuktaḥ**—impelled; **ayam**—one; **pāpam**—sins; **charati**—commit; **pūruṣhaḥ**—a person; **anichchhan**—unwillingly; **api**—even; **vārṣhṇeya**—he who belongs to the Vrishni clan, Shree Krishna; **balāt**—by force; **iva**—as if; **niyojitaḥ**—engaged

Arjuna said: O Krishna! Constrained by force as it were, by what does man commit sin even against his wish?

श्रीभगवानुवाच ।

काम एष क्रोध एष रजोगुणसमुद्भवः ॥

महाशनो महापाप्मा विद्ध्येनमिह वैरिणम् ॥ ३७ ॥

śhrī bhagavān uvācha

kāma eṣha krodha eṣha rajo-guṇa-samudbhavaḥ

mahāśhano mahā-pāpmā viddhyenam iha vairiṇam

śhri-bhagavān uvācha—the Supreme Lord said; **kāmaḥ**—desire; **eṣhaḥ**—this; **krodhaḥ**—wrath; **eṣhaḥ**—this; **rajaḥ-guṇa**—the mode of passion; **samudbhavaḥ**—born of; **mahā-aśhanaḥ**—all-devouring; **mahā-pāpmā**—greatly sinful; **viddhi**—know; **enam**—this; **iha**—in the material world; **vairiṇam**—the enemy

The Blessed Lord said: It is desire, it is anger, born of Rajoguna (the impulse of action), all-consuming and all-evil. Know this as the enemy here.